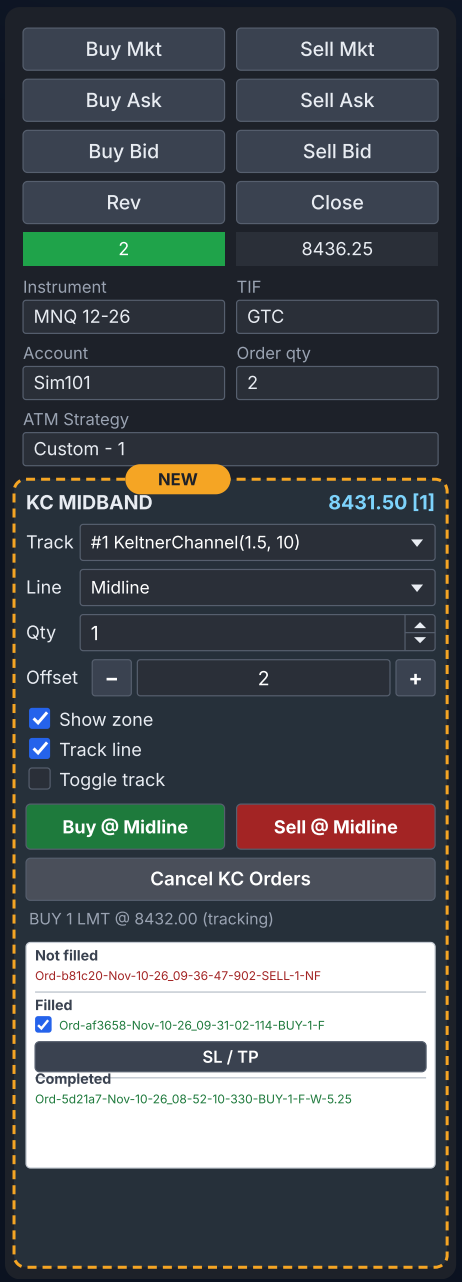
NINJATRADER 8 · NINJASCRIPT INDICATOR

KC Mid Trader

One-click Buy / Sell orders attached to the Keltner Channel midband (with an optional tick offset), built right into Chart Trader.

Conceptualized and developed with AI by **Rangel Alvarado**



1. **Buy @ Midline / Sell @ Midline.** One click places the order at the selected line plus a tick offset (buy above, sell below); the zone is drawn on the chart.
2. **Attached orders.** Working orders follow the line as it moves. *Track* and *Line* pick the indicator and plot; *Toggle track* unlocks any indicator.
3. **EMA-cross and MACD triggers.** Arm a Buy or Sell that stays not filled until a favorable EMA cross, or until MACD crosses a level.
4. **Three order lists.** *Not filled*, *Filled* and *Completed* (W / L with points), each row labelled *Ord-….*
5. **SL / TP.** On one checked fill: keep the ATM, remove a leg, follow an indicator, close the target on an EMA cross, or close on a MACD level.
6. **Own quantity.** Separate contract spinner, 1 by default. Chart Trader Mkt / Bid / Ask orders are listed too.
7. **Cancel KC Orders.** Cancels only what this tool placed — your other orders are untouched.
8. **Follows your Chart Trader.** Selected account and ATM strategy; changing the ATM re-launches unfilled entries and re-prices the stops/targets of the filled orders you check.

Safety first: this tool sends and modifies real orders. Validate it on the **Sim101** account before using a live account. Adding controls to Chart Trader is not an officially supported NinjaTrader feature.

STEP A Install the indicator

You only do this once. Requires NinjaTrader 8 (desktop) and the file `KcMidTrader.cs`.

1. **Copy the file**
   Close nothing. Copy `KcMidTrader.cs` into the Indicators folder (path below).
2. **Open the editor**
   Control Center → **New** → **NinjaScript Editor**.
3. **Compile**
   In the editor press **F5** (or right-click → Compile).
4. **Confirm**
   The bottom panel shows no errors. NinjaTrader adds its generated code automatically.

Destination folder

```
Documents\NinjaTrader 8\bin\Custom\Indicators\KcMidTrader.cs
```

Alternative: in the NinjaScript Editor, right-click *Indicators* → **New Indicator**, name it `KcMidTrader`, finish the wizard, select all the generated text, paste the full contents of `KcMidTrader.cs`, and press F5.

If compilation fails

Message	What to do
Error points to *another* file	NinjaTrader compiles every script together. Fix or remove the broken script it names, then press F5 again.
Type or member not found (e.g. `AtmStrategySelector`)	Your NinjaTrader build may name an internal control differently. Update NinjaTrader 8 to the current release; if it persists, send the exact error line.
"KcMidTrader already defines…"	An older copy exists. Keep only one `KcMidTrader.cs` in the folder.

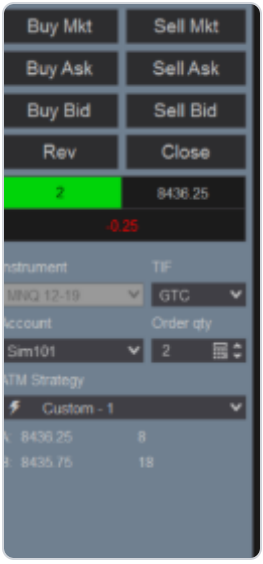
Note: after installing or updating, always do a first run on the Sim101 account before trading a live account.

STEP B Add it to a chart

Do this on every chart where you want the KC buttons.

1. **Open a chart**
   Any instrument and interval you trade.
2. **Add Keltner Channel**
   Ctrl+I → **KeltnerChannel** → Add. Set Period / Offset as usual.
3. **Add KcMidTrader**
   Same dialog → **KcMidTrader** → Add → review its settings → OK.
4. **Show Chart Trader**
   Chart toolbar **Chart Trader** button, or chart Properties → Chart Trader → Visible.

What you should see



Native Chart Trader (before)

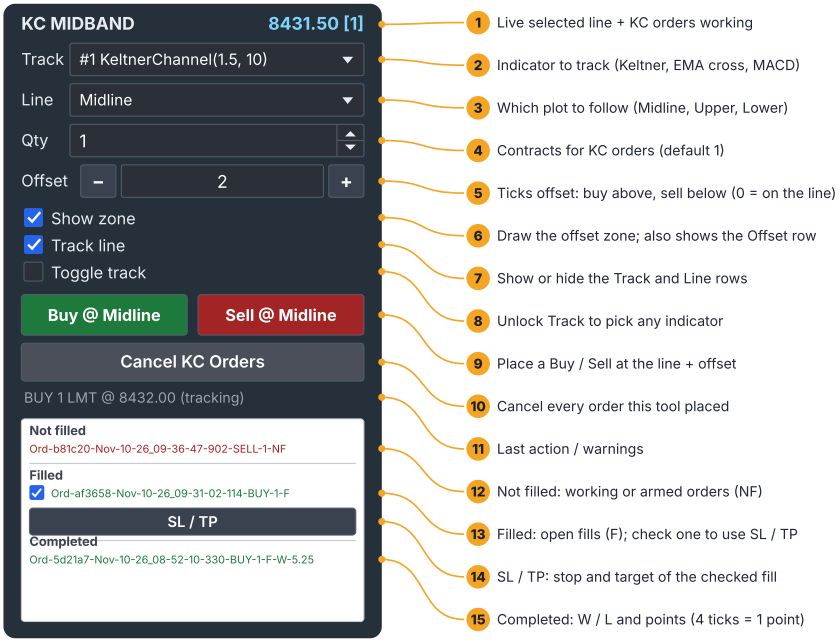
A new **KC MIDBAND** section appears at the bottom of Chart Trader, under the ATM Strategy selector (see the mockup on the cover).

- The selected line value updates live once real-time data arrives. Orders placed by the tool are listed at the bottom in three lists: *Not filled*, *Filled* and *Completed*.
- The **Track** list shows every visible Keltner Channel on the chart (e.g. *#1 KeltnerChannel(1.5, 10)*); the first one is selected by default and the list stays locked until you check **Toggle track**, which opens it to any indicator. **Line** picks which plot to follow (Midline by default). With two or more EMAs on the chart, Track also offers **EMA cross**, and a MACD can be picked too (see page 6).
- Remove or hide the Keltner Channel and the section disappears.
- With several chart tabs, the section follows the active tab.

> **Tip:** save the chart as a template (right-click → Templates → Save) with both indicators, so new charts come ready.

STEP C Using the panel

Fifteen elements, all in one block.



Typical workflow

#	Action	Result
1	Select account (and ATM, if wanted) in Chart Trader	The KC orders use them. Chart Trader's own *Order qty* is **not** used — the KC spinner is.
2	Pick the channel in **Track** and the plot in **Line**	Only needed with several Keltner Channels or to follow Upper/Lower. **Track** is locked until **Toggle track** is checked. Switching re-anchors working KC orders.
3	Set the KC **Qty** with the ▲▼ arrows, mouse wheel or by typing	Defaults to the value in the indicator settings (1).
4	Set the **Offset** with − / + (or type it, or use the wheel)	Buy goes *n* ticks **above** the line, sell *n* ticks **below**. 0 keeps the line price. **Show zone** draws it (light blue above, light red below) and shows this row.
5	Use **Track line** and **Show zone** to save space	Unchecking **Track line** hides the Track and Line rows; unchecking **Show zone** hides the Offset row. Orders keep following the line (plus offset) and the offset keeps applying either way.
6	Click **Buy @ Midline** or **Sell @ Midline**	Order goes in at the line plus offset. The status line confirms, e.g. *BUY 1 LMT @ 8432.00 (tracking)*, and the order appears in *Not filled* as *Ord-...-BUY-1-NF*.
7	Click **Cancel KC Orders**	Cancels every working KC order. Your other working orders are not touched.
8	Check **one** filled order, then click **SL / TP**	Opens the stop-and-target window (page 6). Filled rows move to *Completed* with W / L and points once closed.

Cancel vs. Close: Cancel only removes orders that have **not filled**. Once filled you hold a position — manage it with the native **Close** button or your ATM stops/targets. In the list, filled rows (F) get a checkbox: checked ones have their ATM stop/target re-priced when you change the ATM strategy; unfilled ones (NF) are cancelled and re-submitted with the new ATM.

HOW IT WORKS Attached orders

With tracking on, the working order is re-priced to the selected line (plus offset) until it fills or you cancel it.

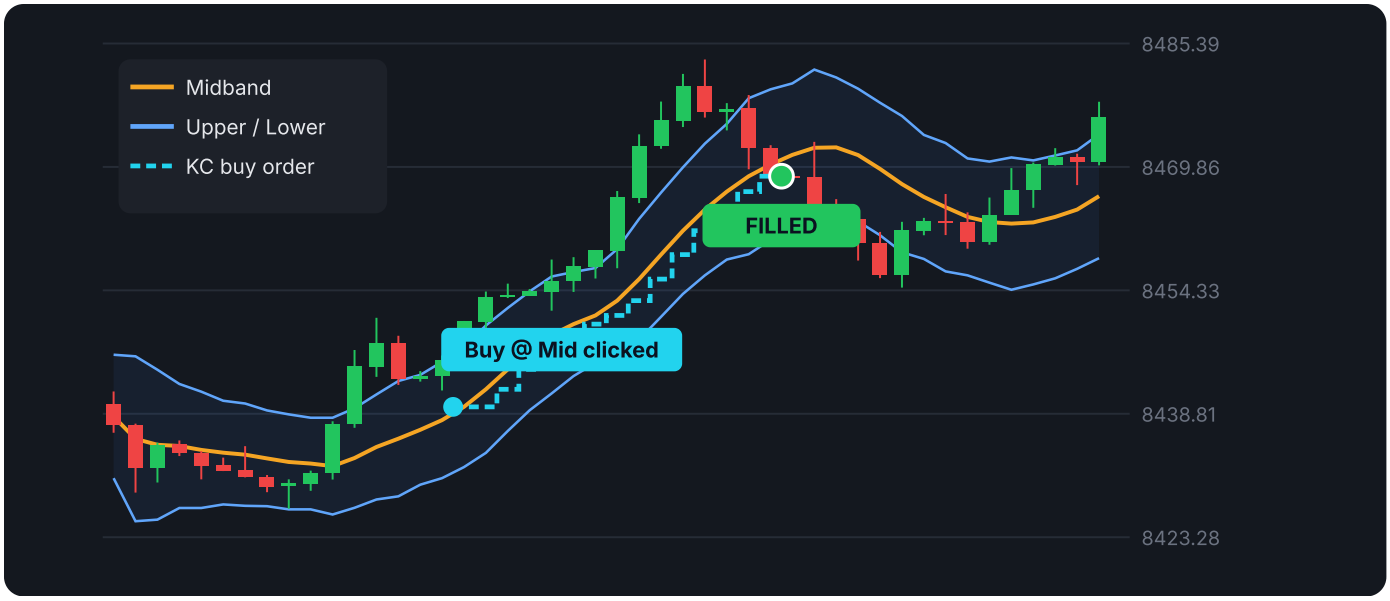


Illustration: a Buy @ Midline order with offset 0 (Buy Limit below price) follows the rising midband and fills when price pulls back into it.

Which order type is used (order price = line ± offset)

	ORDER PRICE ON THE PASSIVE SIDE	ORDER PRICE ON THE OTHER SIDE OF THE MARKET
BUY	Order price **below** the ask → **Buy Limit**.	Order price **above** the ask → **Block** (default) or **Buy Stop Market**.
SELL	Order price **above** the bid → **Sell Limit**.	Order price **below** the bid → **Block** (default) or **Sell Stop Market**.

Track mode

OnPriceChange (default): re-prices whenever the tick-rounded order price moves — tightest tracking.
OnBarClose: re-prices once per bar using the closed bar's line value — fewer modifications.

When the order price crosses the market

Block: tracking pauses and the order stays at its last price; it resumes once the order price is back on the right side.
SwitchToStopMarket: the order is cancelled and, only after the cancel is confirmed, re-submitted as a stop at the order price (never doubled).

ADVANCED Lists, SL / TP, EMA cross & MACD

The three order lists

List	What it shows
Not filled (NF)	Working or armed orders. Unfilled entries are cancelled and re-submitted when you change the ATM strategy.
Filled (F)	Open fills, with a checkbox. Check **one** to enable **SL / TP**; checked fills also get their ATM stop/target re-priced on an ATM change. Chart Trader *Mkt / Bid / Ask* orders are listed here too (the ATM keeps its stop and target).
Completed	Closed trades, e.g. *Ord-...-F-W-5.25* or *-F-L-4.75*. W = win, L = loss; the last number is points (4 ticks = 1 point).

SL / TP window (stop and target of the checked fill)

Leg source	Effect
ATM strategy	Leave the leg on the ATM template.
None	Remove the stop or the target. The position stays open.
Indicator + plot	The leg follows that plot (pick the band in the second list).
EMA cross *(target only)*	Needs two EMAs on the chart. The target closes the position when EMA A crosses EMA B.
MACD + **Value**	Closes the position when the absolute MACD level falls through the value. At 0: a buy closes when MACD crosses down through 0, a sell when it crosses up.

Triggers chosen in **Track**

Track entry	How it works
EMA cross	Needs two EMAs. A window asks for **EMA A** and **EMA B**. Buy stays *not filled* until A crosses **above** B, Sell until A crosses **below** B; then the entry goes in, the ATM stop is kept and the target waits for the next cross. The **Line** list shows *Cross*.
MACD	A window asks for a magnitude. The order price stays the Keltner line you picked in **Line**; MACD is only the trigger. Buy waits for MACD to cross **above** the value, Sell for a cross **below**; then a limit is sent at the Keltner line and the ATM starts.

Closed bars only. EMA and MACD crosses are evaluated on the closed bar. A cross that is **already true** does not open or close anything; it must leave and cross again.

REFERENCE

Settings & troubleshooting

Settings are in the indicator dialog (Ctrl+I → KcMidTrader), group *KC Mid Trader*.

Setting	Default	Meaning
Indicator name contains	Keltner	Indicators whose name contains this text are listed in **Track**.
Default quantity	1	Starting value of the KC quantity spinner.
Track line by default	On	Initial state of the *Track line* checkbox (shows the Track and Line rows).
Track mode	OnPriceChange	When working orders are re-priced (see page 5).
When midband crosses market	Block	Block, or SwitchToStopMarket (applies to the offset price).
Time in force	GTC	TIF for KC orders.
Use Chart Trader ATM strategy	On	If an ATM is selected in Chart Trader, KC entries launch it (stops/targets on fill).
Max ticks offset	100	Ceiling for the Offset box only: a typed value above it is trimmed to it. It is not the offset itself.
Re-adopt working KC orders on reload	On	After a reload/restart, finds non-ATM KC orders (named `KCMid…`) and tracks them again.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Check
KC section does not appear	Is an indicator with “Keltner” in its name on the chart and **visible**? Chart Trader visible? Active chart tab? Open **New → NinjaScript Output**: the tool prints the indicators it sees on the chart.
“Waiting for real-time data...”	Connection is not live yet or the market is closed. Use the Playback or Sim connection to test.
“Blocked: order price ... the market”	A limit there would fill immediately (line plus offset is on the wrong side of the market). Wait, lower the offset, or set *When midband crosses market* to SwitchToStopMarket.
Order does not move	Tracking paused (see status line), Track mode = OnBarClose (moves only at bar close), or an EMA / MACD order still armed (it has no broker order until its cross).
Orders still working after removing the indicator	By design: reloads must not cancel orders. Click **Cancel KC Orders** before removing the indicator.
ATM orders not tracked after a reload	NinjaTrader requires ATM entries to be named “Entry”, so they can’t be identified. Cancel them from the chart or Orders tab.
Track list greyed out or missing	Greyed: it is locked on the Keltner channel by design; check **Toggle track** to pick another indicator. Missing: **Track line** is unchecked, which hides the Track and Line rows (the Offset row is hidden by **Show zone**).
Offset box trims my number	A typed value above *Max ticks offset* (default 100) is trimmed to that ceiling. Raise the setting if you need more.